

ALEXANDRA CHEN

SENIOR SOFTWARE ENGINEER

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Results-driven software engineer with 8+ years of experience designing and building scalable distributed systems. Passionate about clean architecture, developer experience, and mentoring teams. Led initiatives that improved system reliability by 99.95% and reduced deployment times by 60%. Seeking to leverage deep technical expertise in a Staff Engineer role.

EXPERIENCE

Senior Software Engineer — Stripe

Jan 2021 – Present

San Francisco, CA

- Architected and led the migration of a monolithic payment processing service to a microservices architecture, reducing latency by 40% and enabling independent scaling.
- Designed a real-time fraud detection pipeline processing 50M+ transactions daily using Kafka, Flink, and custom ML models, reducing chargebacks by 23%.
- Mentored a team of 6 engineers, establishing code review standards and leading weekly architecture deep-dives that improved team velocity by 35%.
- Implemented comprehensive observability with distributed tracing (Jaeger) and custom Grafana dashboards, cutting mean-time-to-resolution by 50%.

Software Engineer II — Airbnb

Mar 2018 – Dec 2020

San Francisco, CA

- Built the dynamic pricing recommendation engine serving 100K+ hosts, increasing average booking revenue by 18% through machine-learning-driven suggestions.
- Developed a GraphQL federation layer unifying 12 backend services, improving frontend development speed and reducing API response times by 30%.
- Led the adoption of container orchestration (Kubernetes) for 40+ microservices, reducing infrastructure costs by 25% through auto-scaling policies.

Software Engineer — Palantir Technologies

Jun 2016 – Feb 2018

Palo Alto, CA

- Developed data integration pipelines for government analytics platforms handling 2TB+ of daily data ingestion with 99.9% uptime SLA.
- Created an internal developer toolkit that reduced onboarding time for new engineers from 3 weeks to 5 days.
- Collaborated with cross-functional teams to deliver a real-time threat intelligence dashboard used by 500+ analysts daily.

EDUCATION

M.S. Computer Science — Stanford University

2014 – 2016 • Focus: Distributed Systems & Machine Learning | GPA: 3.92/4.0

B.S. Computer Science, Minor in Mathematics — University of California, Berkeley

2010 – 2014 • Magna Cum Laude | GPA: 3.88/4.0

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages	Python	Go	Java	TypeScript	Rust	SQL
Infrastructure	Kubernetes	Docker	Terraform	AWS	GCP	CI/CD
Data & ML	Kafka	Spark	Flink	PostgreSQL	Redis	TensorFlow
Practices	Microservices	System Design	TDD	Agile/Scrum	Tech Lead	

CERTIFICATIONS

- AWS Solutions Architect – Professional (2023)
- Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA) (2022)

OPEN SOURCE PROJECTS

OpenTrace – github.com/alexchen

Open-source distributed tracing library for Go microservices. 2.5K+ GitHub stars, adopted by 3 companies in production.

References available upon request.